

LEARNING HUB

Premium English Learning Resources

Academic English & Essay Writing Toolkit

Plan • Develop • Connect • Edit

SENIOR STUDENTS • UNIVERSITY • EXAM LEARNERS

WRITE

ACADEMIC



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02

Start here

A quick route from notice → practise → speak

YOUR LEARNING MAP

Use the workbook in short, repeatable sessions.

You can work alone, with a tutor, or with a speaking partner. Choose one page at a time rather than trying to finish everything in one sitting.

1 Notice	2 Learn	3 Practise	4 Speak	5 Reflect
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1 • Notice

Read the model language. Circle a phrase you could use this week.

2 • Learn

Say key phrases aloud. Focus on meaning before speed.

3 • Practise

Complete the guided task. Change one detail to make it yours.

4 • Speak

Use the role-play cards. Try once with notes, then once without.

Quick win

Aim for one useful phrase you can actually say in real life today. Small, repeated practice beats one long session.

VOCABULARY THAT DOES A JOB

Learn the phrase, then make it personal.

Tip: do not memorize isolated words only. Notice the whole phrase, the situation, and one example sentence.

Word / phrase	Meaning	Model sentence	Practice note
argue	present a reasoned position	This essay argues that...	Use for thesis/claims.
evidence	information that supports a claim	The evidence suggests that...	Support claims.
however	introduces contrast	However, the results differ.	Academic connector.
therefore	introduces a result/conclusion	Therefore, the policy should be reviewed.	Cause → result.
significant	important or meaningful	The difference is significant.	Formal vocabulary.
demonstrate	show clearly	The results demonstrate a clear trend.	Academic verb.
in contrast	shows a difference	In contrast, Group B declined.	Comparison.
overall	considering the whole picture	Overall, the findings support the argument.	Conclusion language.

Speak it!

Choose three phrases. Say each one with a different detail: person, place, time or reason.

04

Conversation model

Notice how the speakers keep the exchange moving

A CONVERSATION YOU CAN BORROW

Read once for meaning. Read again aloud. Then swap one detail.

A

What's your main argument?

B

My essay argues that practical learning should have a larger role in university education.

A

What evidence will you use?

B

I'll compare student outcomes and discuss two recent studies.

A

How will you structure the paragraph?

B

I'll use a clear claim, evidence, explanation and link back to the thesis.

Notice & borrow

Underline one phrase that keeps the conversation moving (for example: "How about you?"). Write your own version below.

05

Guided practice

Build your answer before you speak

SENTENCE FRAMES

Complete the frame, then say the whole sentence aloud.

01

This essay argues that ____.

02

One important reason is ____.

03

The evidence suggests that ____.

04

However, ____.

05

Therefore, ____.

Your version:

06

Interactive challenge

Match • choose • upgrade

QUICK-CHECK CHALLENGE

Try it without looking back at the vocabulary page.

Match	Term / concept	Meaning
1	argue	A. result
2	evidence	B. contrast
3	however	C. support for a claim
4	therefore	D. present a reasoned position

Upgrade it

Take one basic sentence you could say and make it more natural by adding a reason, time, contrast or follow-up question.

REAL-WORLD SPEAKING PROMPTS

For tutoring: give one card to each learner. For self-study: set a 60–90 second timer.

CARD 01 • Thesis clinic

Give a thesis for one topic in 20 seconds.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

CARD 02 • Evidence check

Explain why one example supports a claim.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

CARD 03 • Paragraph coach

Describe the role of each sentence in a paragraph.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

CARD 04 • Counterargument

State an opposing view and respond to it politely.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

PARAGRAPH BUILDER

Use the four-part structure: claim → evidence → explanation → link.

Move	Question to answer	Starter
Claim	What is your point?	One important reason is...
Evidence	What supports it?	For example, ...
Explanation	Why does it matter?	This suggests that...
Link	How does it support the thesis?	Therefore, ...

Try it!

Write a four-sentence paragraph using the frame. Keep the sentences connected to one main idea.

ESSAY PLANNING BOARD

Plan before you draft. Keep your position visible.

Online learning

Some people believe online learning is more effective than face-to-face learning. To what extent do you agree?

Thesis: _____

Reason 1: _____

Reason 2: _____

Public transport

Cities should invest more in public transport than in roads for private cars. Discuss.

Thesis: _____

Reason 1: _____

Reason 2: _____

Social media

Social media helps people communicate, but it can also reduce meaningful interaction. Discuss both views.

Thesis: _____

Reason 1: _____

Reason 2: _____

University study

Universities should focus more on practical skills than theoretical knowledge. Do you agree?

Thesis: _____

Reason 1: _____

Reason 2: _____

THE 3-LEVEL CHALLENGE

Repeat the same task three ways.

LEVEL 1 • Clear

Give a short answer using one target phrase.

LEVEL 2 • Natural

Add a reason, example or follow-up question.

LEVEL 3 • Flexible

Respond to an unexpected change or disagreement.

Your challenge prompt

GO

60–90 seconds • 1 target phrase • 1 follow-up question • 1 natural repair phrase if you get stuck

Your evidence does not fully support your thesis. Revise the claim or choose stronger evidence and explain why.

MINI REVIEW QUIZ

Try first. Then check the answer key at the end.

1

Choose the more natural phrase: "Repeat." / "Could you say that again, please?"

Answer:

2

Complete: "It ___ on the situation." (depends / dependent)

Answer:

3

What should you do when you do not understand? Name one polite repair phrase.

Answer:

4

Add a follow-up question to: "I prefer studying in the morning."

Answer:

5

Use one target phrase in a sentence about your own life.

Answer:

6

Give one reason for your opinion on a familiar topic.

Answer: _____

CHECK & IMPROVE

Use the key to notice patterns, not just to score yourself.

Task	Suggested answer
Matching activity	1-D, 2-B, 3-C, 4-A
Mini review 1	B – the polite request is more natural.
Mini review 2	A – “It depends on...” is the natural phrase.
Mini review 3	Examples: “Could you say that again, please?” / “I’m afraid I didn’t catch that.”
Mini review 4	Example: “How about you?”
Mini review 5–6	Answers vary. Strong answers use a target phrase and a clear reason.

Tutor note

For speaking tasks, prioritize meaning, intelligibility and useful language. Correct only the errors that matter most for the learner’s goal.

MY PRACTICE TRACKER

Tick a box each time you complete a focused practice round.

Skill	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Notes
Vocabulary				
Guided speaking				
Independent task				
Challenge mode				

Confidence check

- ☐ I can start a conversation without overthinking.
- ☐ I can ask for clarification politely.
- ☐ I can use new vocabulary in a real sentence.
- ☐ I can keep speaking when I need more time.

One skill I want to improve next:

Thank you

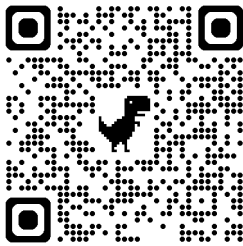
A little practice, used often, goes a long way.

THANK YOU FOR CHOOSING LEARNING HUB

We hope this resource makes English practice feel more practical, focused and enjoyable.

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